



05<sup>th</sup> March 2025

ATSAF Academy  
Council for Tropical and Subtropical Agricultural Research  
University of Hohenheim, Stuttgart

Dear Sir/Madam,

**RE: Recommendation for Mr. Lokesh Goud Dabbi's ATSAF Academy Fellowship Application**

I, Dr. Leigh Winowiecki, write to express my full support for Mr. Lokesh Goud Dabbi's application for the ATSAF Academy Fellowship Program. As a soil scientist and Global Lead of the Soil and Land Health Division at CIFOR–ICRAF (World Agroforestry, Nairobi), I confirm our commitment to supporting Mr. Dabbi's Internship cum Master's thesis project, which focuses on the **“Long-Term Assessment of Soil Properties under Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF) Compared with Conventional Rice Cropping Systems”**.

This research aligns closely with the ongoing work of CGIAR-World Agroforestry's sustainable Soil and Land Health goals. We are confident that this project will contribute significantly to the field and offer valuable insights into APCNF farming practices.

Mr. Dabbi will be hosted by our partner organization Raithu Sadhikara Samstha (RySS), at the APCNF-managed office and experimental station in West Godavari, Andhra Pradesh, India, where he will conduct his research under the mentorship of Dr. Zakir Hussain from APCMNF. His research and stay will be supported by the ATSAF Junior Tandem Scientist Program fellowship provided by the ATSAF Academy, and although the exact duration of his stay will be determined upon approval of his application, we anticipate that he will spend up to six months at the APCMNF office, starting in April 2025. Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF) is being implemented by RySS.

Throughout his research, Mr. Dabbi will receive mentorship from myself, the guidance of his academic supervisor, Professor Dr. Thomas Müller, at the University of Hohenheim, and directly supported by Dr. Hussain from APCNF at the field level in Andhra Pradesh. We are confident that this arrangement will provide Mr. Dabbi with a comprehensive and enriching research experience.

I strongly support Mr. Dabbi's application for this fellowship, as it will not only further his academic and professional development but also contribute to the research agendas of CGIAR, the University of Hohenheim, and APCNF.

Should you have any further questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

Leigh Ann Winowiecki, Ph.D  
Global Research Leader: Soil and Land Health  
Co-lead: Coalition of Action 4 Soil Health (CA4SH) <https://www.coalitionforsoilhealth.org/>